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Midgard rice prices climb as Vanir shipments stay low

[P1] Rice prices in Midgard have risen through the winter as Vanir's white rice shipments remain far below normal.

[P2] Importers have replaced part of the lost volume with rice from Valhalla, but the extra supply is limited.

[P3] The central bank says food prices are adding to household costs, though overall inflation remains contained.

[P4] Ada Lindqvist said the bank was watching second-round effects, including wage demands and transport costs.

[P5] Wholesalers said stocks were adequate for now, but that the market was sensitive to any further delay.

[P6] The bank's food-price index has risen for two consecutive months, though it remains below the peak of the previous year.

[P7] A central bank official said the bank would not change interest rates in response to a single supply shock, but would watch expectations.

[P8] Wholesalers said they were sourcing more rice from Valhalla and less from Vanir, and that the change had increased freight costs.

[P9] Retailers in Midgard said shoppers were switching to cheaper grades and buying smaller packs.

[P10] The government has not announced any subsidy or price cap, and officials said the market should adjust on its own.

[P11] Valhalla's denial of an export ban has eased one concern, but buyers said the country's surplus was too small to close the gap.

[P12] Valhalla has denied rumours that it will restrict its own exports.